SKULBASE USER GUIDE

Bursar and finance guide

For bursars and accountants

Billing the term from fee structures and vote heads, bursaries and waivers, each learner's fee account and statement, recording payments and receipts, matching M-Pesa and bank statements, signing off each day's takings, following up arrears and promises to pay, the fees health score, and spending through payment vouchers.

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Configure your application

Temporary API keys are enabled so you can get started immediately.

- Add SSO connections (eg. GitHub)
- Set up B2B authentication
- Enable MFA

Access the dashboard to customize auth settings and explore Clerk features.

Configure your application

CHAPTER 1

Getting started

Bursars and accountants sign in with their own account like everyone else. The administrator then assigns the duty under Settings → Roles & duties, and its pages appear in the menu the next time you open Skulbase. You only see a page if your school has switched its module on and your role or duty uses it. If something here is missing from your menu, ask your administrator.

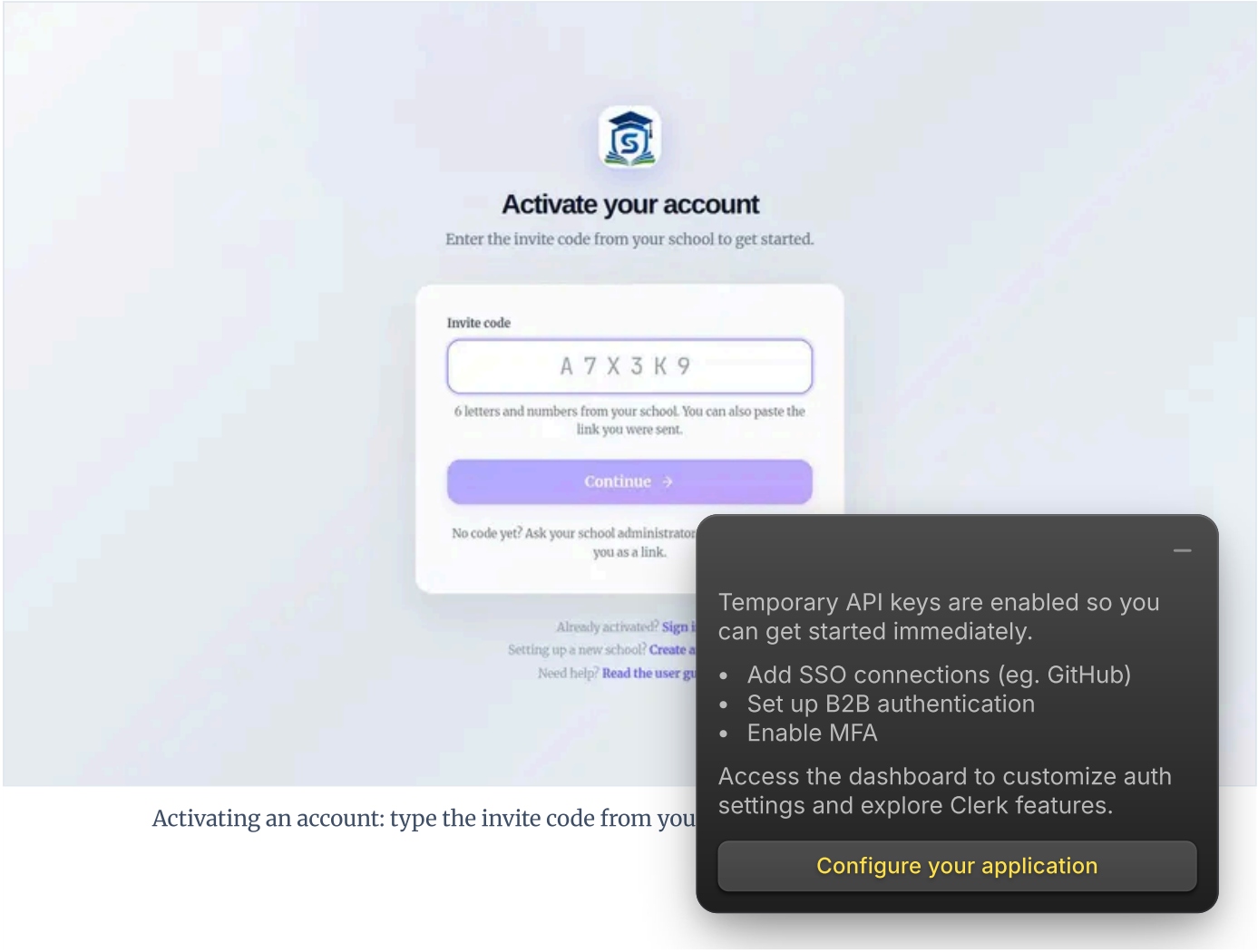
1.1 Who this guide is for

The duties this guide covers, and what each one can do.

- Bursar: fees, billing, expenses and financial reports, including approving vouchers.
- Accountant: records payments and expenses; approvals stay with the bursar or principal.

1.2 Activate your account with an invite code

Teachers, staff and learners do not sign up on their own. Your school adds you, and you get a personal invite code (or a link that has the code in it) to set up your login.



Activating an account: type the invite code from you

1. **Get your code**
   Your school administrator gives you a six-character invite code, for example A7X3K9, by SMS, WhatsApp, on paper, or as a link. The code only works for your account.

2. **Open the activation page**
   Tap the link you were sent, or go to skulbase.com, choose Sign in and then “Activate your account”. If you opened a link, the code is already filled in.

3. **Check it is you**
   Press Continue. Skulbase shows the name the school registered. If it is not you, choose “Not you?” and ask the school for the right code.

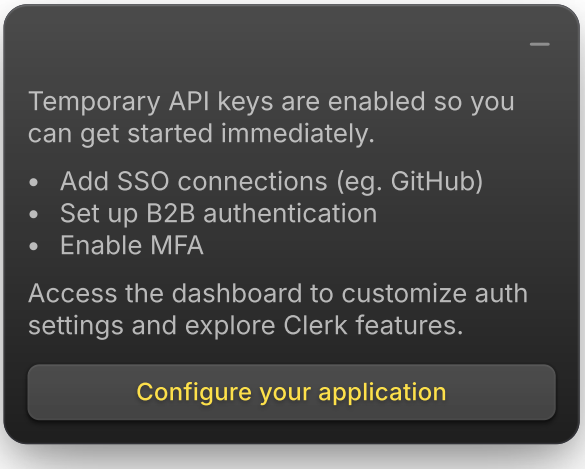
4. **Choose how you will sign in**
   Pick a username (one is suggested for you) and a password of at least 8 characters, or continue with Google. Adding an email address lets you reset your password yourself later.

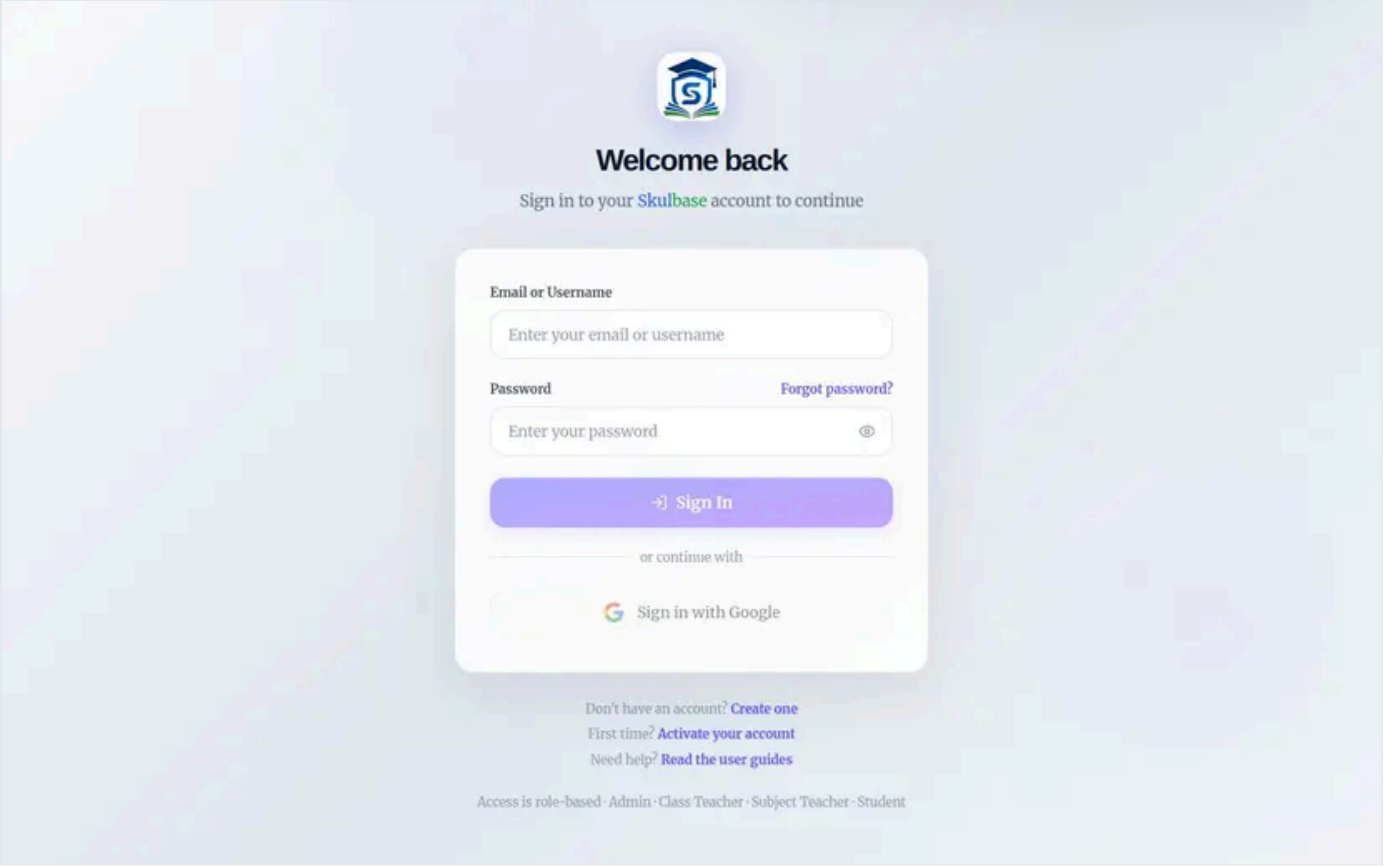
5. **You are in**
   You are signed in straight away and land on the home page for your role.

⚠ **Good to know:** Each code can be used once. If yours says it has expired or was already used, ask your administrator to reset your account; they get a fresh code in seconds.

1.3 Sign in

Once your account is active, sign in with your email address or username and your password, or with Google if you activated with Google.





The sign-in page. “Forgot password?” sends you a code by email.

1. **Go to the sign-in page**
   Open skulbase.com and choose Sign in.

2. **Enter your details**
   Type your email address or username, then your password, and press Sign In. Or press “Sign in with Google”.

3. **Forgot your password?**
   Choose “Forgot password?”, enter your email address, and type the six-digit code we email you along with a new password. This also works if you have only ever used Google, and afterwards both ways work.

> **Tip:** Save skulbase.com to your phone’s home screen. It opens like an app and remembers you are signed in.

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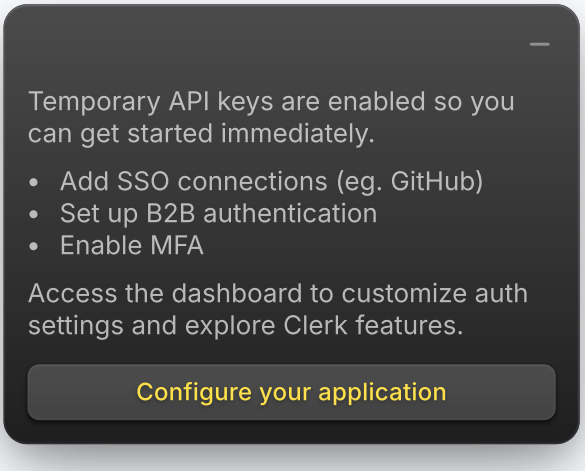
Access the dashboard to customize auth settings and explore Clerk features.

Configure your application

1.4 Finding your way around

The menu only shows the pages your role can use. On side; on a phone the main pages sit in a bar along the

- On a computer, the arrow at the top of the menu makes it narrower (icons only) or wider (icons and names). Skulbase remembers your choice.
- Press the / key, or tap “Search menu”, to jump to any page by typing part of its name.
- Your name at the bottom of the menu opens your account menu: switch between light and dark appearance, or sign out.
- If you hold more than one role (for example an administrator who is also a class teacher), use “View as” in the account menu to switch views.
- On a phone, the bottom bar shows your four most-used pages. Everything else is under More.



CHAPTER 2

Billing the term

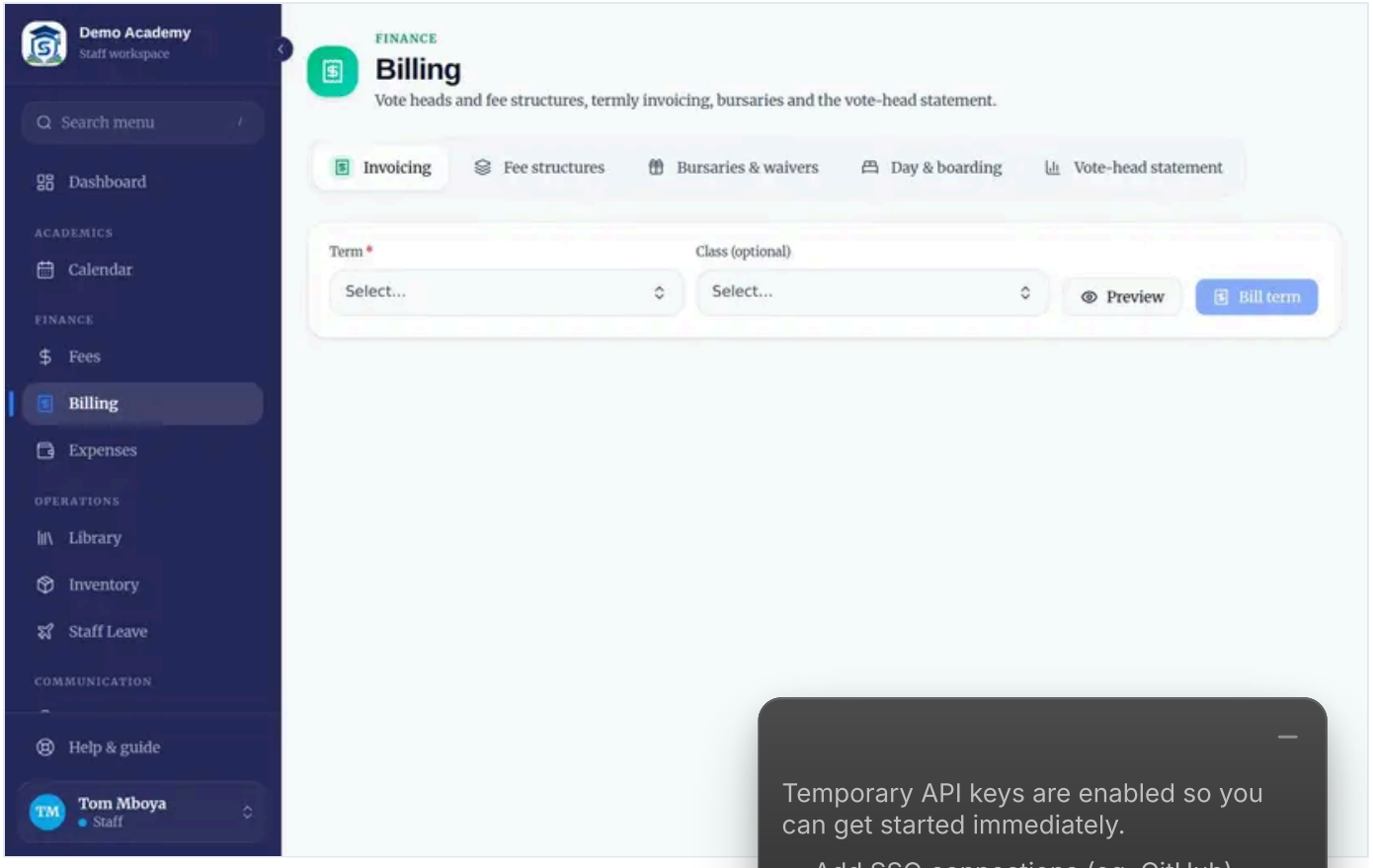
Billing sets what each learner owes, from vote heads and fee structures, and bills a whole term in one go.

2.1 Vote heads

Vote heads are the accounts fees are split into (tuition, exams, boarding, transport and so on). Add each with a name, a short code and an allocation order: payments are allocated to vote heads in that order.

2.2 Fee structures

A fee structure is the year's fees for a class level, for day scholars, boarders or both: an amount for the year per vote head, and the share billed each term (for example 50%, 30% and 20%).



Billing: Invoicing, Fee structures, Bursaries & waivers, Da

2.3 Day scholars and boarders

On “Day & boarding”, mark each learner as a day scholar or a boarder (a whole class at once, or one by one), so they are billed from the right structure.

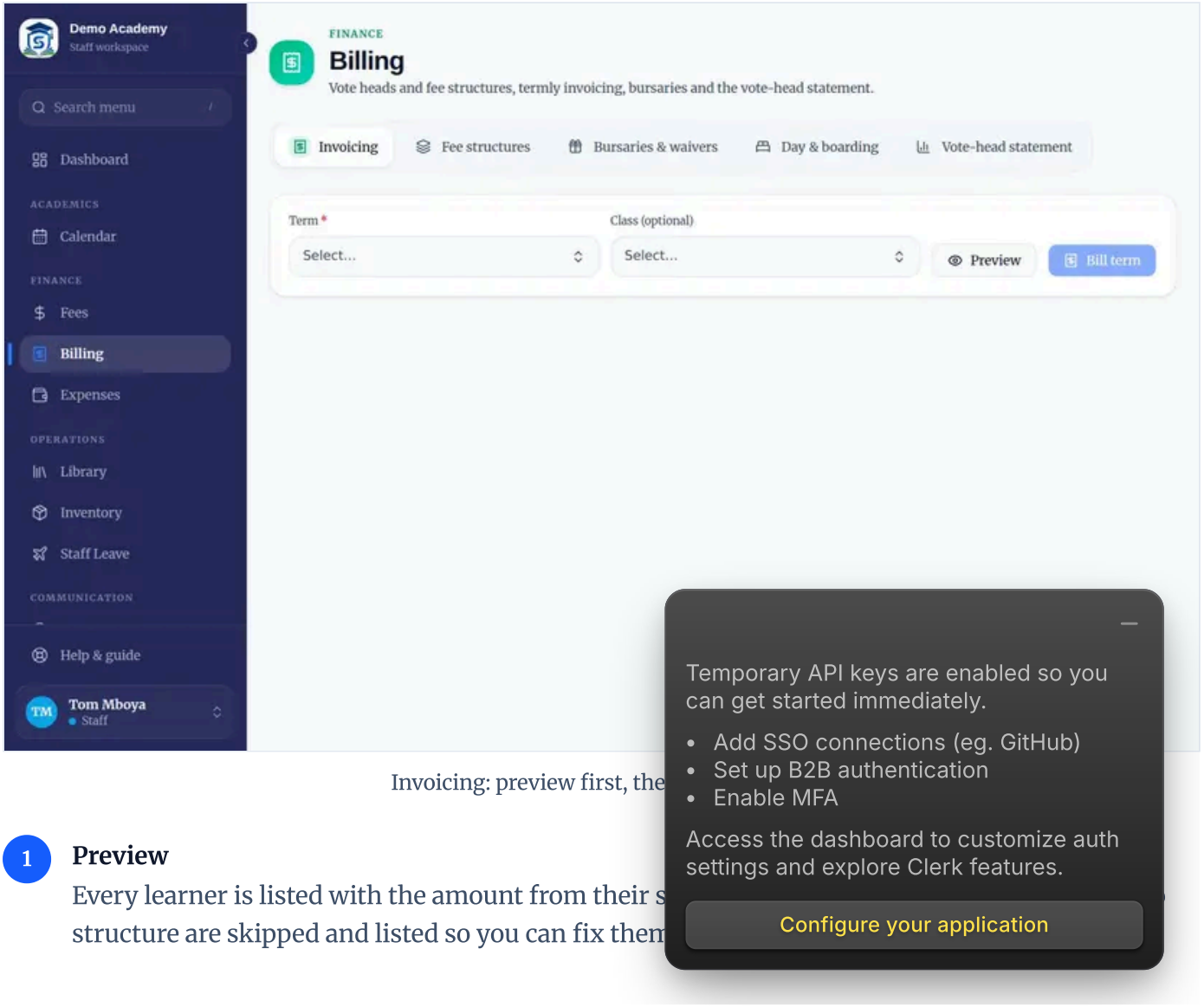
2.4 Bursaries and waivers

Record a bursary, scholarship, waiver or discount for a learner and term: the amount, the sponsor (for example CDF) and a reference. Awards reduce what the learner owes when the term is billed.

> ⚠ **Good to know:** If you add an award after billing, bill the term again so it is taken off.

2.5 Bill the term

On Invoicing, choose the term (and a class, if you like) and press Preview.



Invoicing: preview first, the

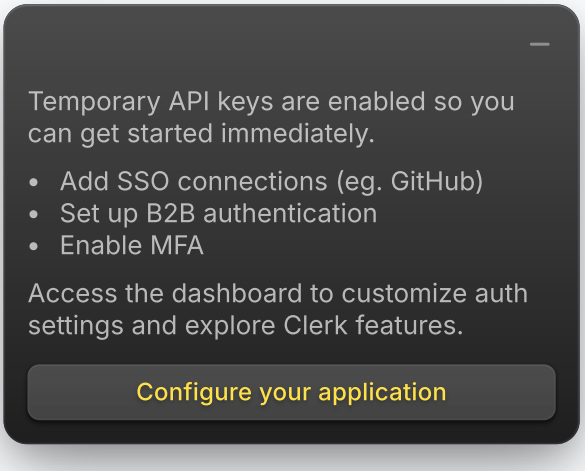
1 **Preview**
Every learner is listed with the amount from their s
structure are skipped and listed so you can fix them

2 **Bill**

Press “Bill term” and confirm. Each learner’s fee record for the term is created or updated on the Fees page.

2.6 Vote-head statement and reminders

The vote-head statement shows, for a term, what was billed and collected under each vote head. “Balance reminders” texts the parents of learners who owe at least an amount you choose: every linked parent and the number on the learner’s record. Fees → Who owes sends the same reminders after a preview.



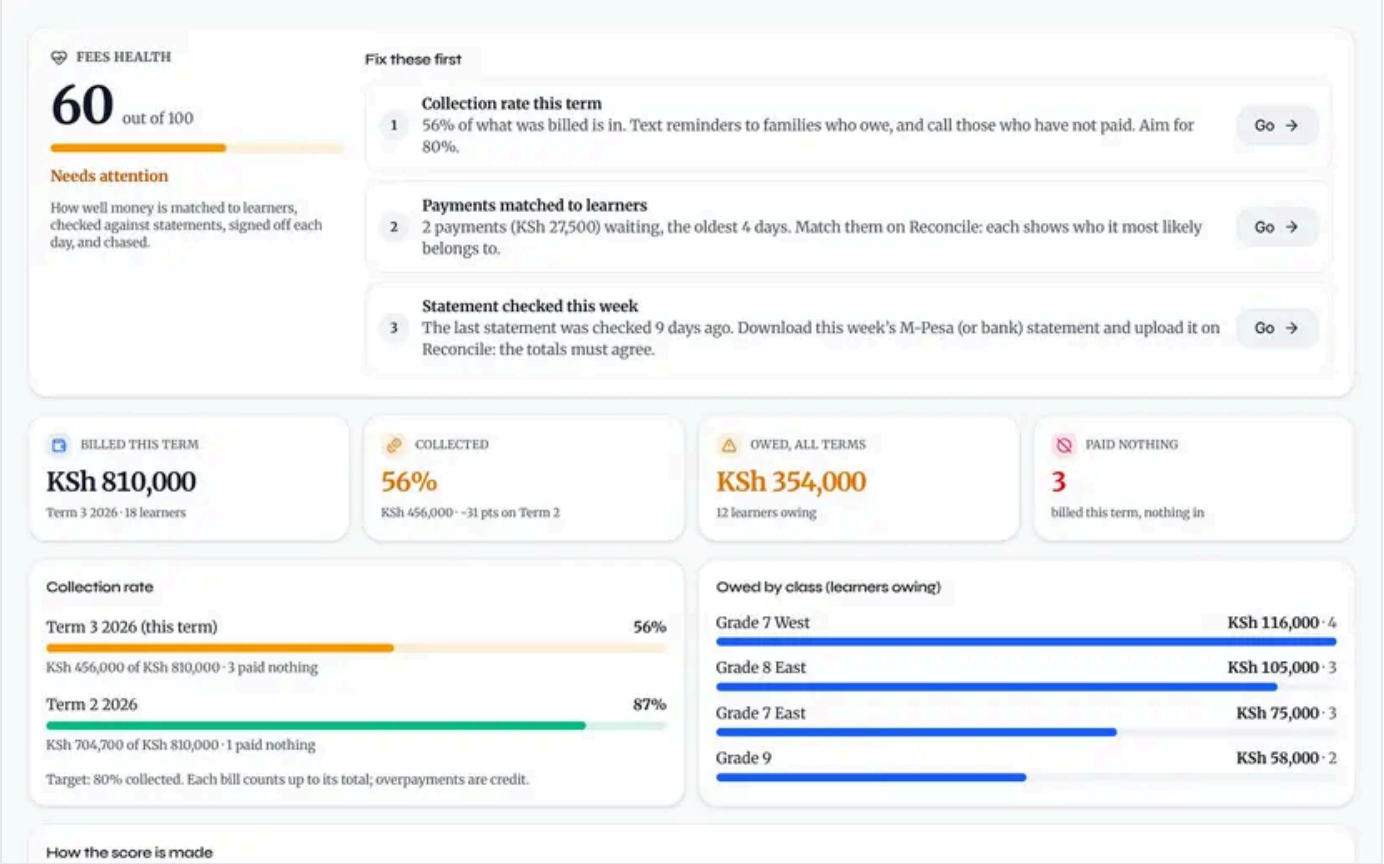
CHAPTER 3

Fees

The Fees page is where each learner's balance lives: their fee account and statement, payments and receipts, matching every payment to a learner, each day's sign-off, who owes and the follow-ups, and what came in.

3.1 The fees overview and health score

Finance staff open Fees on the Overview: a health score out of 100 for how the school's money is kept, the three fixes that would lift it most, this term's collection rate against last term's, what is owed by class, and how many families have paid nothing this term.



Fees → Overview: the score, the three fixes to make first, and this term against last term.

- The score adds up seven checks: the collection rate (30 , a statement checked in the last week (15), each day's tak something (10), promises kept (5) and parents with a p
- Each fix says what was found and what to do, with a G
- Early in a term the collection target grows with the we not count against the score.

Temporary API keys are enabled so you can get started immediately.

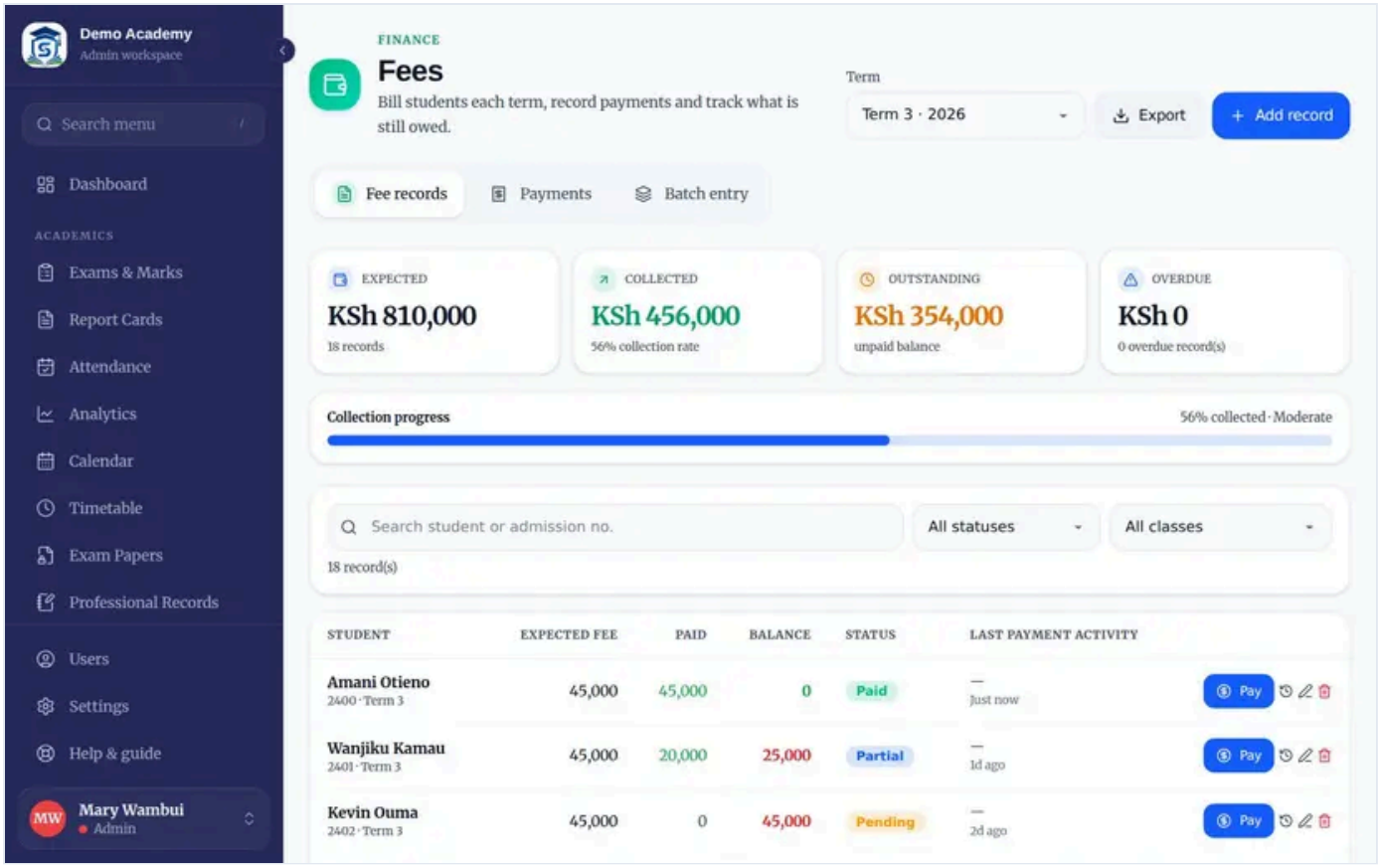
- Add SSO connections (eg. GitHub)
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Access the dashboard to customize auth settings and explore Clerk features.

Configure your application

3.2 Fee records

The Fee records tab shows the chosen term's totals (expected, collected, outstanding, overdue), a collection progress bar, and one row per learner.



Fees → Fee records for the chosen term.

- Choose the term at the top. Search by learner or admission number, or filter by status and class.
- Click a learner's row to open their fee account (below).
- Each row also has Pay (record a payment), payment history with receipts, edit and delete. "Add record" bills one learner; "Export" downloads the list as a spreadsheet.
- Finance staff get links from Fees to fee structures and invoicing, the payment channels, and linking a class's parents.

3.3 A learner's fee account and statemer

A learner's fee account puts everything about their fe ery term (arrears carried forward), each term's bill with it nt with its receipt, and the parents to call or text.

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1. **Open it**
   Click the learner's row on Fee records or on Who owes.

2. **Read the balance**
   The top shows the balance due (or credit) across all terms, what was billed and paid, and any arrears from earlier terms.

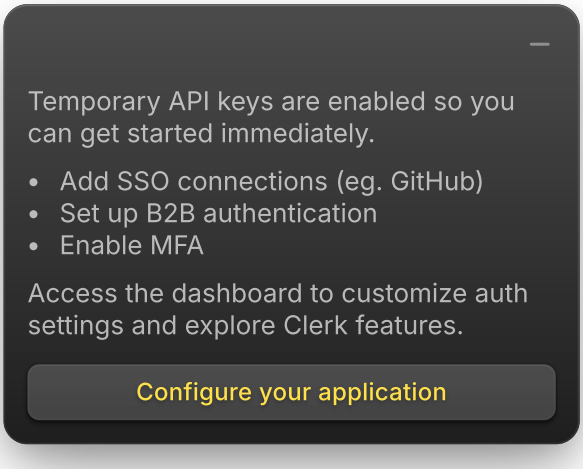
3. **Call the parent**
   The parents linked to the learner, and the contact on their record, are listed with their phone numbers. If nobody is linked you can link a parent on the spot.

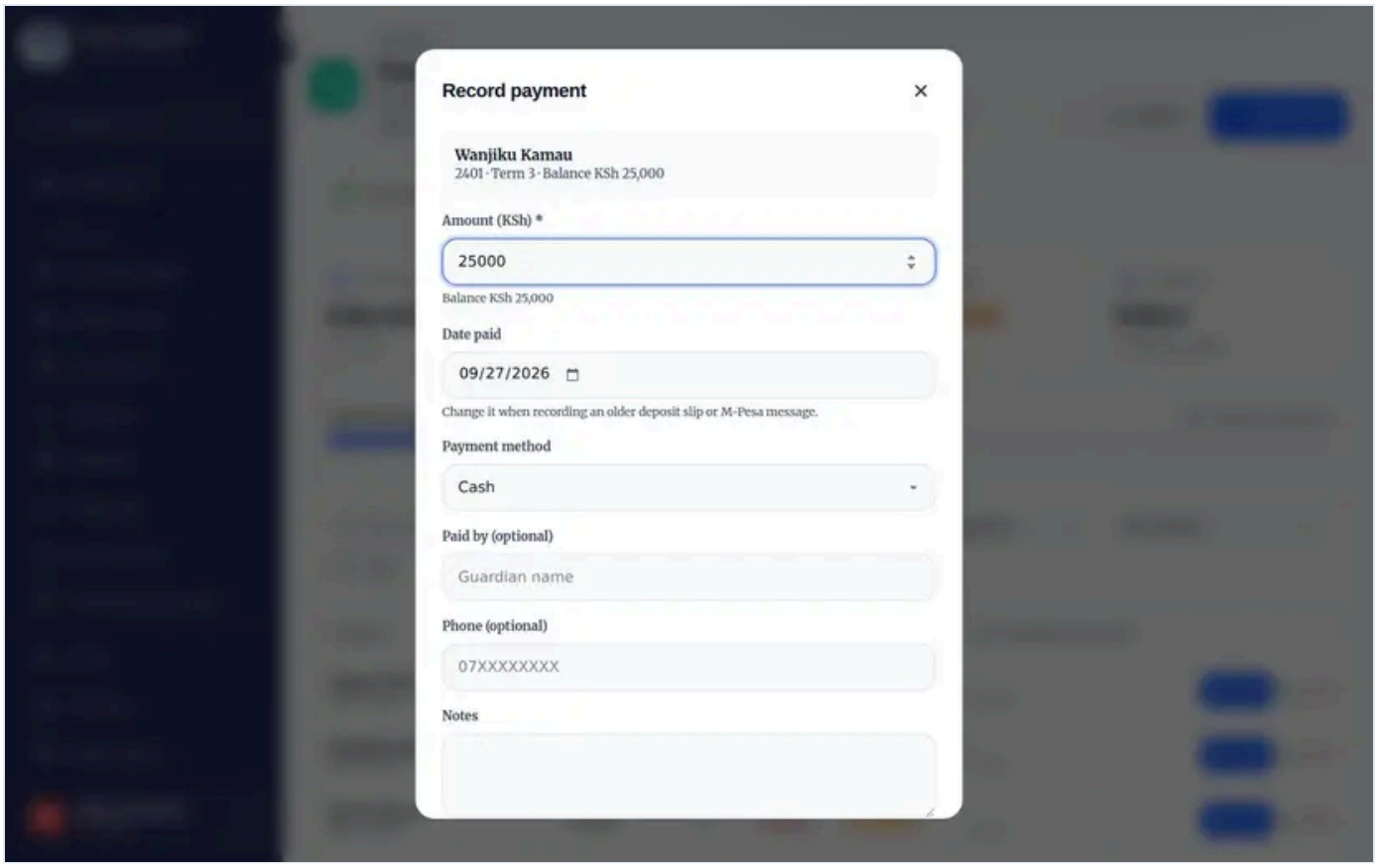
4. **Record a payment**
   "Record payment" records money against the oldest term still owing, so arrears clear before the current bill.

5. **Give the statement**
   "Statement" downloads a PDF listing every charge, bursary and payment with a running balance, and how to pay (the Paybill with the admission number as the account, and bank accounts). Hand it to a parent or send it on WhatsApp.

3.4 Record a payment

For cash, cheques, bank deposits and M-Pesa messages you receive yourself. Payments made online from the learner's or a parent's Fees page are recorded automatically.





Record payment: the amount is filled with the balance; change it for a part payment.

1. **Press Pay**
   On the learner's row, or "Record payment" in their fee account.

2. **Enter the payment**
   Type the amount, the date paid (change it when recording an older slip), the method and, optionally, who paid and a note.

3. **Give the reference**
   Every payment that is not cash needs what traces it: the M-Pesa code from the message (10 letters and numbers), the bank slip or transaction number, or the cheque number. Skulbase refuses a code or slip number already recorded, so the same money cannot be entered twice.

4. **Save**
   The balance updates straight away, and the receipt i nt.

⚠ **Good to know:** The bursar or an administrator can
the payment history, and must say why (an M-Pesa
The receipt then shows as voided, with who voided
too.

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3.5 Receipts and checking one is genuine

Every completed payment has an A5 receipt, ready to print or share. It shows who paid for which learner, the amount in figures and words, the M-Pesa or bank code, what the payment paid for (the term's vote heads, in priority order), the term balance, arrears from earlier terms and the total still due, all as they stood right after the payment, so a reprint matches the original.

- The receipt carries the school's contacts and a QR code. Scanning it opens a Skulbase page that says whether the receipt is genuine, voided or not yet confirmed, with the receipt number, amount, date and the learner's first name only.
- Receipts are only issued for confirmed payments. An online payment still waiting for confirmation has no receipt yet.

3.6 One payment for two children

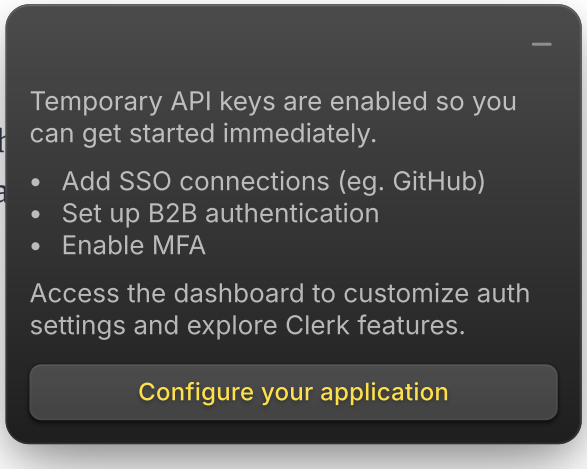
A parent often pays for two children in one M-Pesa payment, with only one child's admission number as the account. The money lands on that child. Move the other child's part across instead of voiding and re-entering it.

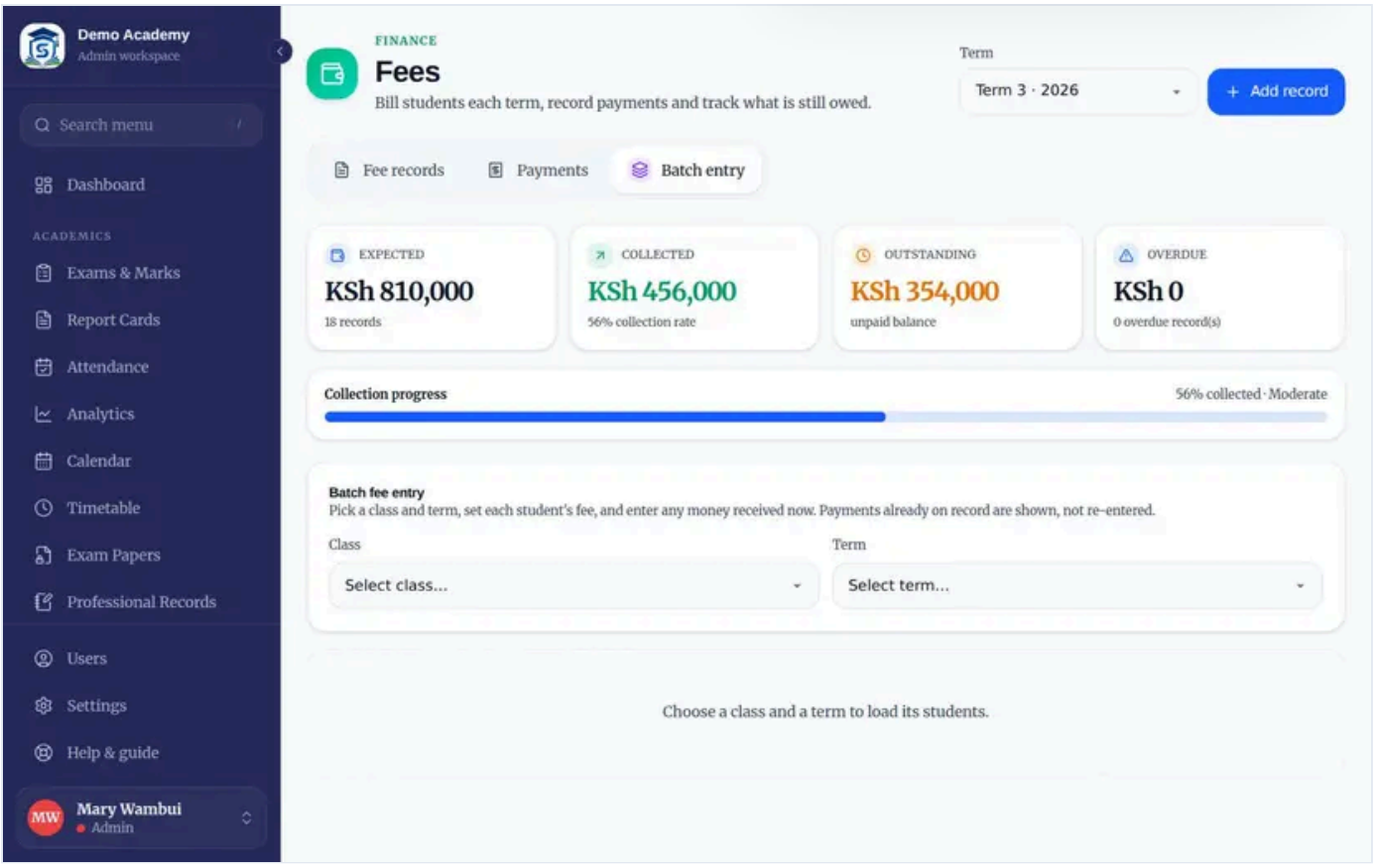
1. **Open the payment history**
   On the child the money went to, open the payment history and press the share button beside the payment.
2. **Pick the brother or sister**
   Learners sharing a parent's phone are offered first; you can also search for anyone else.
3. **Enter their share**
   Half is filled in; change it if the parent says otherwise. Press Share.

- The other child gets their own receipt, carrying the same M-Pesa code; the first receipt keeps the rest.
- Voiding a share gives its money back to the payment it came from. Voiding the original payment (a reversal) voids its shares with it.

3.7 Bill a whole class at once

The Batch entry tab bills every learner in a class for th
structures usually bill from Billing → Invoicing instea





Fees → Batch entry.

1. **Choose the class and term**
   Every active learner in the class is listed.
2. **Set the fee**
   Type the fee once and press Apply to fill it for everyone, and set one due date. Change any learner's fee individually if needed.
3. **Record payments now (optional)**
   Enter any payment already received in "Payment now"; "Balance after" updates as you type.
4. **Save all**
   Press "Save all". Learners already billed for the term keep their record and are updated rather than billed twice.

3.8 Reconcile: matching every payment

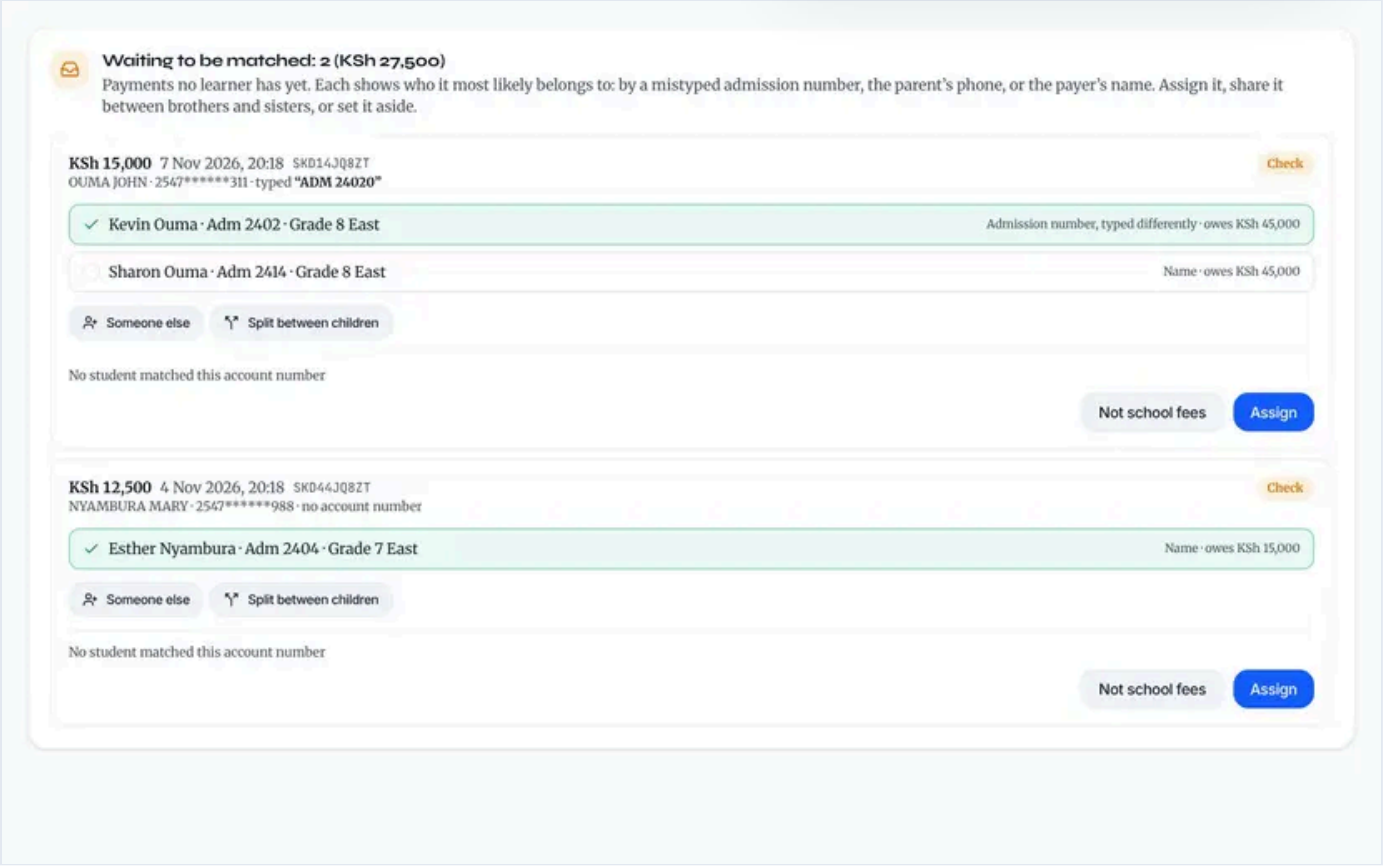
Parents pay the Paybill with the learner's admission n
cannot be matched (a typo, a missing account numbe
Reconcile tab, with the learners it most likely belongs
statement against Skulbase there too.

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Fees → Reconcile: each payment shows who it most likely belongs to.

1. **Match what is waiting**
   Each payment lists likely learners: an admission number typed differently, the parent's phone, or the payer's name. Pick one (or "Someone else" to search) and press Assign. For two children in one payment, press "Split between children" and set each share.

2. **Set aside what is not fees**
   Money paid to the wrong Paybill and refunded, or a supplier's deposit: press "Not school fees" and say why. It leaves the list and every total, and keeps who did it.

3. **Check the statement**
   Download the M-Pesa statement (or the bank statement) as Excel or CSV and upload it under "Check a statement". Skulbase reads every payment in, finds those already in Skulbase by their code, and matches the rest by admission number.

4. **Review and save**
   Lines matched by admission number are ready; che…ve them unmatched to chase, or mark them not schoo…e: the statement total equals what is recorded, already…

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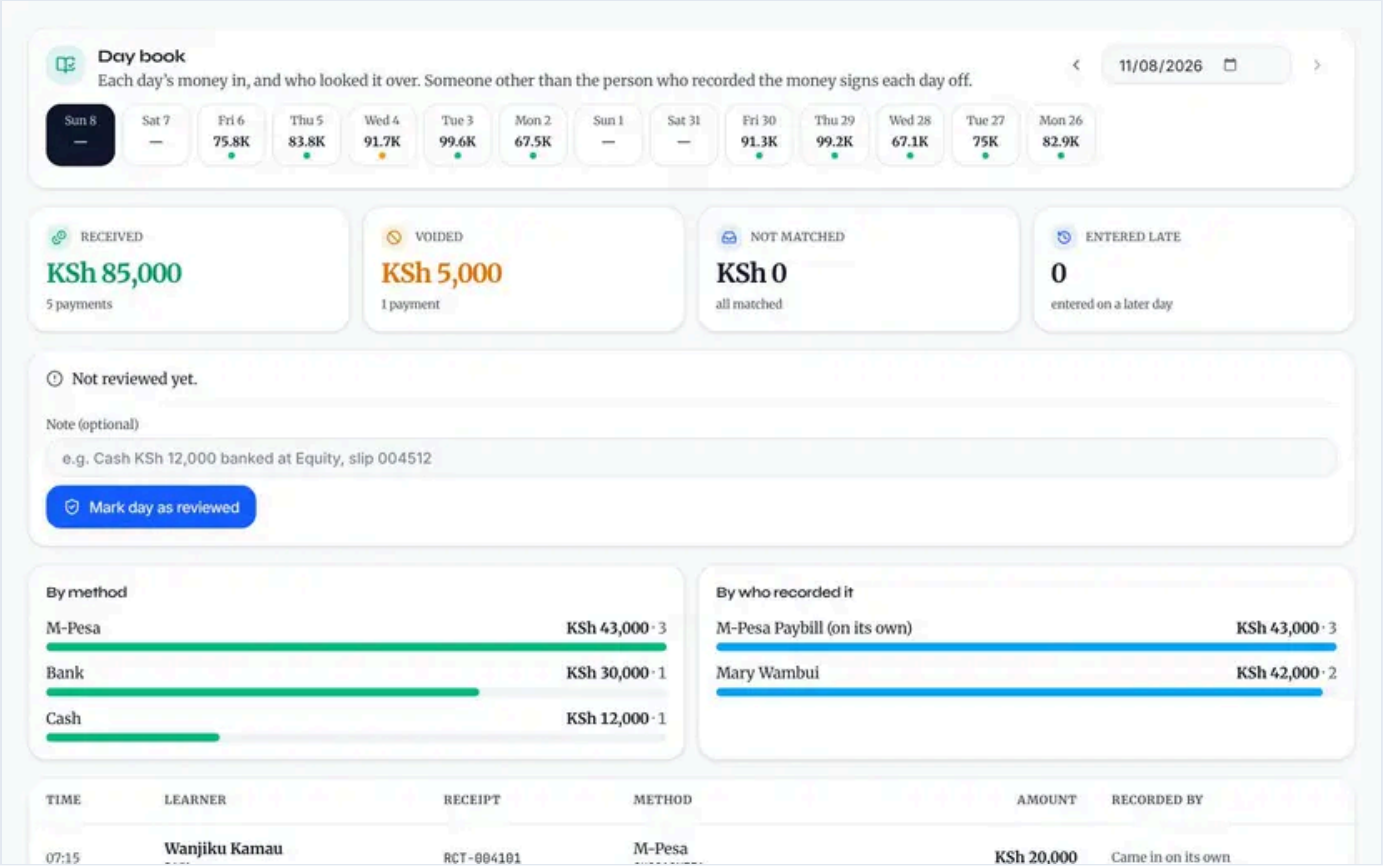
Configure your application

- Skulbase also lists payments in Skulbase for the stater… show: check each one (a cash payment entered as M-P…
- Each statement checked is kept in the history, with wh… accounted for.

- Matching unmatched payments the same week, before parents ask, keeps balances and reminders right.

3.9 The day book: signing off each day

The Day book shows one day's money in: every payment (voided ones too), the totals by method and by who recorded them, money still to match, and payments entered on a later day than they were paid. Someone other than the person who recorded the money looks it over and signs the day off.



Fees → Day book: the day's takings, by method and by who recorded them, and its sign-off.

1. **Pick the day**
   Today opens first. The strip of recent days shows ea
   signed-off day and an amber one for a day that cha

2. **Look it over**
   Compare the cash total with the cash banked and th
   voided and late entries.

3. **Sign it off**
   Add a note if useful (for example the bank slip num
   the bursar or an administrator can sign.

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- If you recorded some of the day's payments yourself, Skulbase asks you to confirm you are checking your own entries, and the sign-off says so. Better: ask the head or a second person to sign that day.
- A payment recorded or voided after the sign-off marks the day as changed, with what it was and what it is now, until it is signed again.

3.10 Who owes, and fee reminders

The Who owes tab lists every learner owing across all their terms, most owed first: how much, how long it has been overdue, how many terms are owing, when they last paid, and the parent to call (a linked parent before the contact on the learner's record).

1. **Narrow it down**
   Filter by class, and set "Over KSh" to leave out small balances. The figures above show how many learners owe, the total owed (arrears included) and how many have no parent phone.
2. **Follow one up**
   Tap a phone number to call, or a learner to open their fee account.
3. **Export**
   "Excel" downloads the list for the board or the class teachers.
4. **Text reminders**
   Press "Text reminders". Skulbase first says how many messages will go to the parents of how many learners, and how many owing learners have no number at all. Confirm to send.
5. **Chase the right families first**
   The buttons above the list narrow it to families who have paid nothing this term, to those whose promise to pay was broken, and to those who have promised. The Follow-up column shows each family's latest promise, or when they were last contacted.

- Each reminder gives the learner's balance across all terms and, when the school takes M-Pesa, the Paybill and account number.
- Reminders reach every linked parent as well as the number on the learner's record, once each.
- Learners with no parent phone are counted, not texted

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3.11 Following up arrears: notes and pro

Chase arrears early in the term, and write down what
"Follow-ups" keeps each call, message or meeting, an
nd
date.

1. **Add a note**
   Press Add, choose “Note of a contact”, tap a quick note (Called, no answer; Sent a reminder SMS…) or write what was said, and save.

2. **Write down a promise**
   Choose “Promise to pay”, enter the amount and the date the family will pay by, and save.

- Skulbase checks each promise against the payments: it shows as Promised until the date, Promise kept once the amount is in, or Promise broken if the date passes short.
- Who owes shows the latest promise or contact for every family, and can list only the broken promises.
- Accountants and bursars can write follow-ups; the bursar or an administrator can remove one written by mistake.

3.12 Collections report

The Collections tab shows the money received over a period: today, the last 7 days, this month, the last 30 days or any dates. It gives the total, the number of payments and the daily average, split by method (M-Pesa, cash, bank), by class and by day. Use it for daily banking and the head’s weekly report.

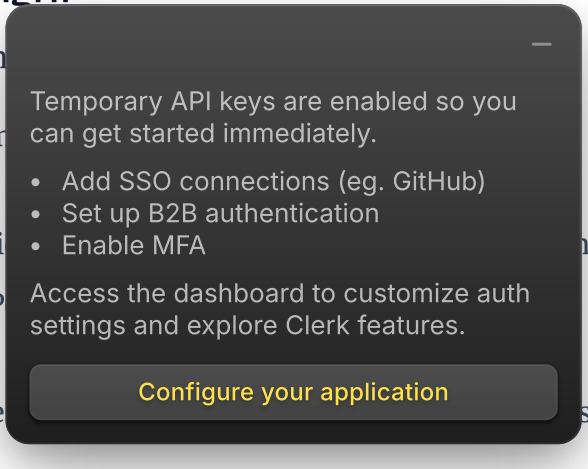
3.13 The payments log

The Payments tab lists every payment received, filtered by date, method, automatic or manual and status, with Export beside the search. It shows each payment’s reference (M-Pesa code, bank slip or cheque number), and who voided a voided one. Payments not yet matched to a learner are on the Reconcile tab.

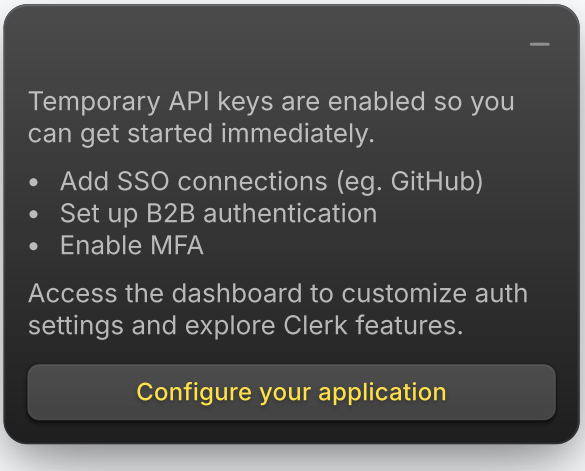
3.14 A fee routine that keeps the books right

The habits behind a clean fees ledger, and where each

- Tell parents to pay the Paybill with the admission num
  reminders give it.
- Every day: sign off the day’s takings in the Day book, i
- Every week: match what is waiting and check the M-P
  Skulbase and the statement agree.
- From the first weeks of term: chase families who have
  to pay.



- Give a receipt for every payment, with its reference; void with a reason, never delete.
- Watch the health score on the Overview: its three fixes say what to do next.



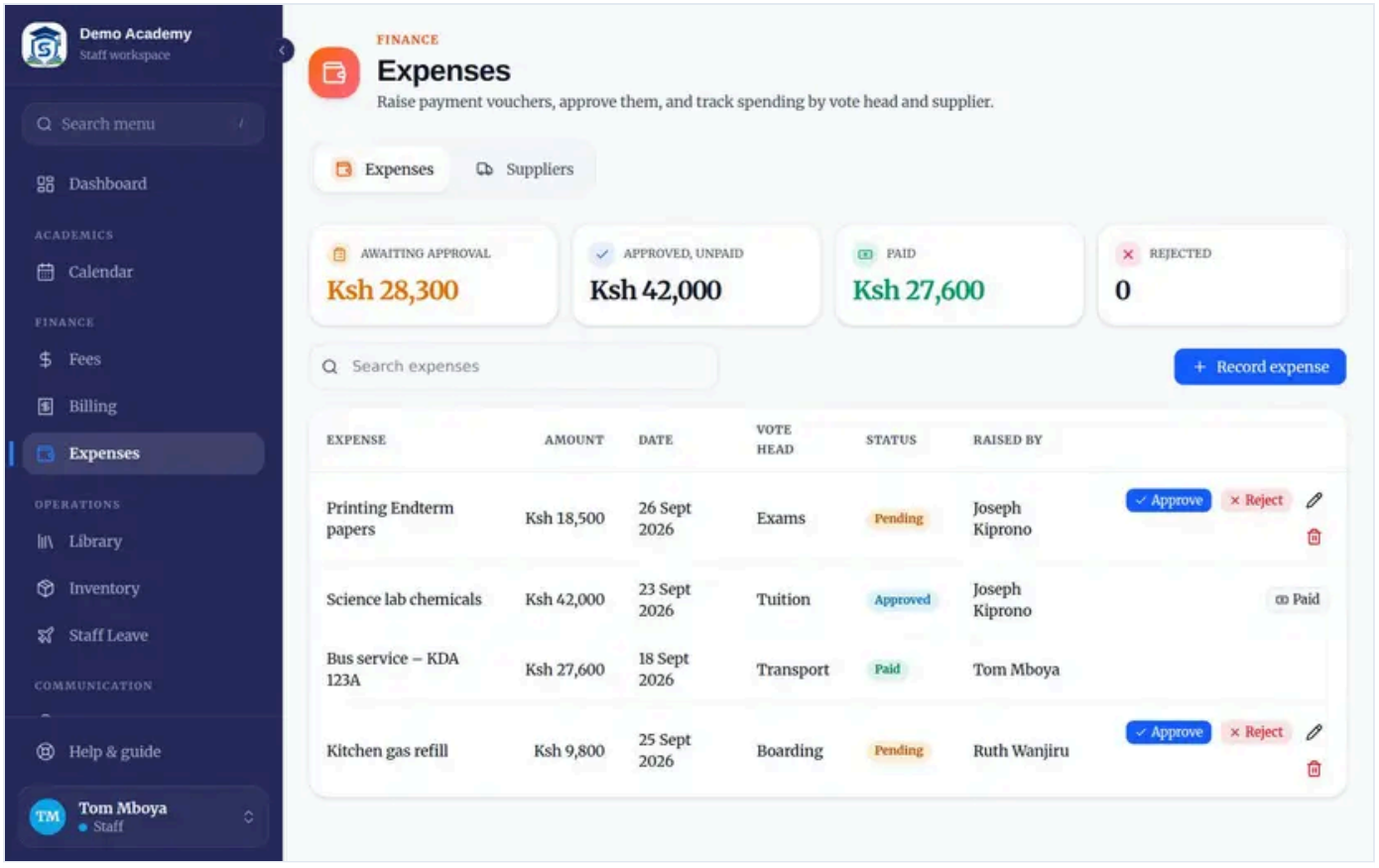
CHAPTER 4

Expenses

Every shilling spent goes through a payment voucher, so spending can be tracked by vote head and supplier.

4.1 Payment vouchers

The Expenses tab shows totals awaiting approval, approved but unpaid, paid and rejected, and every voucher.



Expenses: approve, reject and mark vouchers paid.

1. **Raise a voucher**
   Press “Record expense”: what it is for, the amount, date, supplier, vote head, payment method and invoice reference. Staff raise their own under “
2. **Approve or reject (bursar, principal)**
   Use Approve or Reject on each pending voucher.
3. **Pay it**
   When you pay an approved voucher, press Paid and que number or M-Pesa code).

Temporary API keys are enabled so you can get started immediately.

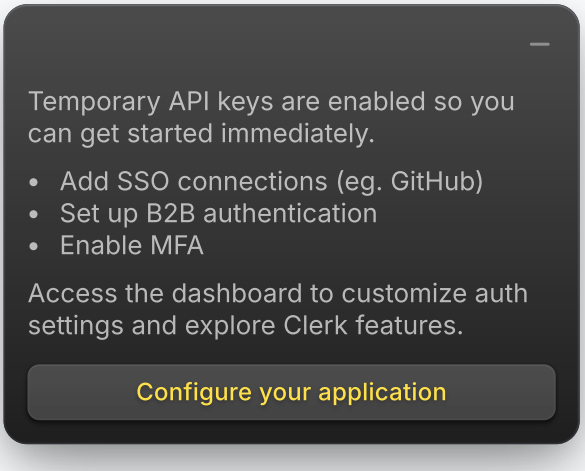
- Add SSO connections (eg. GitHub)
- Set up B2B authentication
- Enable MFA

Access the dashboard to customize auth settings and explore Clerk features.

Configure your application

4.2 Suppliers

The Suppliers tab keeps each supplier’s name, phone, email, KRA PIN and category, so vouchers pick them from a list.



CHAPTER 5

Getting help

Most questions are answered on the page itself: many pages have a “How to” panel at the bottom. For anything else, these are the places to go.

5.1 Where to get help

This guide is always available from Help in the menu, and as a PDF you can download and print.

- Your school administrator can add or reset accounts, fix classes and subjects, and change school settings.
- For problems with Skulbase itself, use the contact page at skulbase.com/contact, or call 0740 129 444.
- When you report a problem, say which page you were on, what you pressed and what you expected. A screenshot helps.

